College Scorecard Data Dictionary

Complete Column Reference for `college_scorecard_fully_cleaned.csv`

1. CORE IDENTIFICATION & INSTITUTIONAL METADATA

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`id`	Integer	Raw	IPEDS / College Scorecard primary unit identifier. Ex: `100654`
`school_id`	String	**Cleaning**	Standardized string identifier for joins. Ex: `"100654"`
`school.name`	String	Raw	Official name of the institution. Ex: `"Alabama A & M University"`
`label`	String	**Cleaning**	Unique display label; appends state if name is duplicated. Ex: `"Columbia University (NY)"`
`flag_name_dup`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	True if institution name is shared by multiple schools. Ex: `True`, `False`
`latest.school.state`	String	Raw	Two-letter state postal abbreviation (territories excluded). Ex: `"AL"`, `"CA"`
`location.lat`	Float	Raw	Latitude coordinates of main campus. Ex: `34.783368`
`location.lon`	Float	Raw	Longitude coordinates of main campus. Ex: `-86.568502`
`latest.school.institutional_characteristics.level`	Integer	Raw	Institutional level code (1 = 4-year, 2 = 2-year, 3 = <2-year). Ex: `1`
`latest.school.ownership`	Integer	Raw	Control code (1 = Public, 2 = Private Non-Profit, 3 = Private For-Profit). Ex: `1`
`ownership_label`	String	Raw/App	Human-readable control status. Ex: `"Public"`, `"Private Non-Profit"`

2. ADMISSIONS & SELECTIVITY METRICS

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`latest.admissions.admission_rate.overall`	Float	Raw	Overall undergraduate admission rate (0.0 to 1.0). Ex: `0.5795`
`admit_rate_pct`	Float	**App**	Admission rate expressed as percentage (0–100%). Ex: `57.95`
`latest.admissions.sat_scores.average.overall`	Float	Raw	Average cumulative SAT score. Ex: `938.0`

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`latest.admissions.act_scores.25th_percentile.cumulative`	Float	Raw	25th percentile cumulative ACT score. Ex: `14.0`
`latest.admissions.act_scores.75th_percentile.cumulative`	Float	Raw	75th percentile cumulative ACT score. Ex: `19.0`
`has_sat`	Integer	**Cleaning**	Flag indicating presence of SAT average (`1` or `0`).
`has_act`	Integer	**Cleaning**	Flag indicating presence of both ACT percentiles (`1` or `0`).
`has_admit`	Integer	**Cleaning**	Flag indicating presence of admission rate (`1` or `0`).
`n_components`	Integer	**Cleaning**	Count of reported selectivity metrics (0 to 3). Ex: `3`
`has_all_three`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	True if institution reports SAT, ACT, and admission rate.
`score_tier`	Category	**Cleaning**	Selectivity tier derived from available standardized metrics. Ex: `"High Selectivity"`

3. COST & TUITION METRICS

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`latest.cost.tuition.in_state`	Float	**Cleaning**	In-state tuition ($0 values converted to missing). Ex: `10558.0`
`latest.cost.tuition.out_of_state`	Float	**Cleaning**	Out-of-state tuition ($0 values converted to missing). Ex: `19318.0`
`latest.cost.tuition.in_state_is_zero`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	Flag indicating raw in-state tuition was reported as $0. Ex: `False`
`latest.cost.tuition.out_of_state_is_zero`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	Flag indicating raw out-of-state tuition was reported as $0. Ex: `False`

4. STUDENT OUTCOMES & DEMOGRAPHICS

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`latest.student.size`	Float	Raw	Total undergraduate degree-seeking enrollment. Ex: `6124.0`
`flag_size_missing`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	Flag marking if enrollment size was missing in raw data. Ex: `False`

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`size_plot`	Float	**Cleaning**	Enrollment size backfilled with median for visualization. Ex: `6124.0`
`latest.student.demographics.student_faculty_ratio`	Float	Raw	Student-to-faculty ratio. Ex: `19.0`
`flag_sfr_outlier`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	Flag marking student-faculty ratio exceeding 3x IQR. Ex: `False`
`latest.completion.completion_rate_4yr_150nt`	Float	Raw	Completion rate for 150% normal time (6-yr rate). Ex: `0.2771`
`latest.student.retention_rate.four_year.full_time`	Float	Raw	Retention rate for full-time undergraduates. Ex: `0.6989`
`latest.completion.outcome_percentage.full_time.not_first_time.8yr.transfer`	Float	Raw	8-year transfer-out rate for non-first-time students. Ex: `0.2524`

5. POST-GRADUATION EARNINGS

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`latest.earnings.10_yrs_after_entry.median`	Float	Raw	Raw median earnings 10 years after entry. Ex: `41266.0`
`latest.earnings.6_yrs_after_entry.median`	Float	Raw	Raw median earnings 6 years after entry. Ex: `35382.0`
`earn10_filled`	Float	**Cleaning**	10-year earnings filled with 6-year earnings if missing. Ex: `41266.0`
`earn10_is_fallback`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	Flag indicating 10-year earnings was imputed from 6-year value. Ex: `False`
`flag_e6_gt_e10`	Boolean	**Cleaning**	Anomaly flag indicating 6-year earnings exceed 10-year earnings. Ex: `False`

6. ACADEMIC PROGRAMS (CIP CODES)

COLUMN NAME	TYPE	STAGE	DESCRIPTION & VALUES
`latest.academics.cip_2_digit.cip_11`	Integer	Raw	Computer & Information Sciences program indicator (`1` or `0`).
`latest.academics.cip_2_digit.cip_14`	Integer	Raw	Engineering program indicator (`1` or `0`).
`latest.academics.cip_2_digit.cip_52`	Integer	Raw	Business, Management, & Marketing indicator (`1` or `0`).
`latest.academics.cip_2_digit.cip_11_pct`	Integer	**App**	Percentage scale for CIP 11 presence (`0` or `100`).
`latest.academics.cip_2_digit.cip_14_pct`	Integer	**App**	Percentage scale for CIP 14 presence (`0` or `100`).
`latest.academics.cip_2_digit.cip_52_pct`	Integer	**App**	Percentage scale for CIP 52 presence (`0` or `100`).